

7. **Invest in your retirement.** Whether you choose a 401(k) or an IRA, start planning now for your retirement. If you start early, you get the power of compound interest on your side. The later you start, the more money per month you will need to contribute.
8. **Don't buy a home until you are ready.** I know buying a home is part of the American dream, but if you make this purchase before you're ready it can be a nightmare.
9. **Don't compare yourself to others.** If you see other people buying expensive things, it does not mean you should. Focus on your budget and live within your means.
10. **Enjoy your life.** Remember, because you are young, financial responsibility is not a painful sacrifice. You do not need to decide between fun and finance; you can have both. When you have extra money, spend it on something that is going to make you truly happy.